

A Valentinian Exposition, with On the Anointing, On Baptism A and B, and On the Eucharist A and B

XI 22, 1-39, 39

[...] enter [...] the abundance [...] those who [...] I will speak] my mystery [to those who are] mine and [to those who will be mine]. Moreover it is these who [have known him who] is, the Father, that [is, the Root] of the All, the [Ineffable One who] dwells in the Monad. [He dwells alone] in silence, [and silence is] tranquility since, after all, [he was] a Monad and no one [was] before him. He dwells [in the Dyad] and in the Pair, and his Pair is Silence. And he possessed the All dwelling within him. And as for Intention and Persistence, Love and Permanence, they are indeed unbegotten.

God came forth: the Son, Mind of the All, that is, it is from the Root of the All that even his Thought stems, since he had this one (the Son) in Mind. For on behalf of the All he received an alien Thought since there was nothing before him. From that place it is he who moved [...] a gushing [spring].

Now this [is the] Root [of the All] and Monad without any [one] before him. Now the second [spring] exists in Silence and [speaks] with him alone. And the [Fourth] accordingly is he [who] restricted himself [in the] Fourth: while dwelling in the Three-hundred-sixtieth, he first brought himself (forth), and in the Second [he] revealed his will [and] in the Fourth he spread himself [out].

While these things are due to the Root of the All, let us for our part [enter] his revelation and his goodness and his descent and the All, that is, the Son, the Father of the All, and the Mind of the Spirit; for he was possessing this one before [...] He [is] a [spring]. He is [one] who appears [in Silence], and [he is] Mind of the All dwelling secondarily with [Life]. For he is the projector [of] the All and the [very] hypostasis of the Father, that is, [he is] the [Thought] and his descent below.

When he willed, the First Father revealed himself in him. Since, after all, because [of him] the revelation is available to the All, I for my part call the All “the desire of the All.” And he took such a thought concerning the All—I for my part call the thought “Monogenes.” For now God has brought Truth, the one who glorifies the Root of the All. Thus it is he who revealed himself in Monogenes, and in him he revealed the Ineffable One [...]

[...] the Truth. [They] saw him [dwelling] in the Monad [and] in the Dyad [and] in the Tetrad. [He] first brought forth [Monogenes and Limit]. And Limit [is the separator] of the All [and the confirmation of the All], since they are [...] the hundred [...]. He is the [Mind ...] the Son. [He is] completely [ineffable] to the All, and he is the confirmation and [the] hypostasis of the All, the [silent veil], the [true] High Priest, [the one who has] the authority to enter the Holies of Holies, revealing the glory of the Aeons and bringing forth the abundance to (fragrance).

The East [...] that is] in [him. He is the one who revealed himself as] the primal [sanctuary] and [the] treasury of [the All]. And [he] encompassed the All, [he] who is higher [than the] All. These for their part [sent] Christ [forth to establish her] just as [they] were established [before her] descent. [And they say concerning] him: [...] He is not manifest, but invisible] to [those remaining within Limit].

And he possesses four powers: a separator [and a] confirmer, a form-provider [and a substance-producer]. Surely [we alone] would discern their presences and the time and the places which [the] likenesses have confirmed because they have [...] from these [places ...] the love [...] is emanated [...] the entire Pleroma [...]. The persistence [endures] always, and [...] for also [...] the time [...] more [... that is], the proof of his [great love].

So why a [separator] and a confirmer and a substance-producer and a form-provider as others have [said]? For [they] say concerning [Limit] that he has two powers, [a] (separator) and [a confirmer], since it separates [Depth] from the Aeons, in order that [...]

These, then [...] of [Depth ...]. For [...] is] the form [...] the Father of the [Truth ... say] that Christ [...] the Spirit [...] Monogenes [...] has [...]

[It is a great and] necessary thing for us to [seek with] more diligence and [perseverance] after the scriptures and [those who] proclaim the concepts. For about [this] the ancients say, “[They] were proclaimed by God.” So [let us] know his unfathomable richness!

[... he wanted ... servitude ...] he [did not] become [...] of their life [...] [...] they look] steadfastly [at their book] of knowledge and [they regard one another’s appearance].

[That] Tetrad [projected the Tetrad which is the one consisting of] Word and [Life and Man and] Church. [Now the Uncreated One] projected Word and Life. Word is [for] the glory of the Ineffable One while Life is for the glory of [Silence], and Man is for his own glory while Church is [for] the glory of Truth. This, then, is the [Tetrad] begotten according to [the likeness] of the Uncreated (Tetrad). And [the] Tetrad is begotten [...] the Decad (i.e., ten) from [Word and Life] and the Dodecad (i.e., twelve) from Man], and [Church became a] Triacontad (i.e., thirty). [Moreover], it is the one [from the Triacontad] of the [Aeons who bear fruit] from [the Triacontad]. [They] enter [jointly but they] come forth [singly, fleeing from] the Aeons [and the Uncontainable Ones. And] the Uncontainable Ones, [once they had] looked [at him, glorified Mind] since [he is an Uncontainable One that exists] in the [Pleroma].

[But the Decad] from Word and Life brought forth decads so as to make the Pleroma become a hundred, and the Dodecad from Man and Church [brought] forth and [made] the Triacontad so as to make [the three] hundred sixty become the Pleroma of the year. And the year of the Lord [...] perfect ... perfect [...] according to [...] Limit and [...] Limit [...] the] greatness which [...] the [goodness ...] him. Life [...] suffer [...] by the face [...] in the presence of the [Pleroma ...] which he wanted [...] And] he wanted to [leave] the Thirtieth—being [a syzygy] of Man and Church, that is, Sophia—to surpass [the Triacontad and] bring the Pleroma [...]

[...] his [...] but [...] and] she [...] the [All ...] but [...] who [...] the All [...]. He made [...] the thoughts and [...] the] Pleroma through the Word [...] his flesh. These, then, [are the Aeons that] are like them. After the [Word] entered it, just as [I] said before, also [the one who comes to be] with the Uncontainable One [brought] forth [...]

[...] before they [...] forth [...] hide him from [...] the syzygy and [...] the movement and [...] project the Christ [...] and the seeds [...] of the cross since [...] the imprints] of the nail wound [...] perfection. [Since it is] a perfect form [that should] ascend into [the Pleroma], he did not [at all] want [to] consent to the suffering, [but he was] detained [...] him by Limit, that is, by the syzygy, since her correction will not occur through anyone except her own Son, whose alone is the fullness of divinity. He willed within himself bodily to leave the powers and he descended. And these things

(passions) Sophia suffered after her son ascended from her, [for] she knew that she dwelt in a [... in unity] and [restoration. They were] stopped [...] the brethren [...] these. A [...] did not [...] became [...]. Who indeed [are] they? [The ...], on the one hand, stopped her [...], on the other hand, [...] with the [...] her. These [moreover are those who were] looking at me, these who [... these] who considered [...] the [death]. They were stopped [...] her and she repented [and she] besought the Father of the [truth], saying, “Granted that I have [renounced] my consort. Therefore [I am] beyond confirmation as well. I deserve the things (passions) I suffer. I used to dwell in the Pleroma putting forth the Aeons and bearing fruit with my consort.” And she knew what she was and what had become of her.

So they both suffered; they said she laughs since she remained alone and imitated the Uncontainable One, while he said she [laughs] since she cut herself off from her consort.

[...] Indeed [Jesus and] Sophia revealed [the creature]. Since, after all, the seeds [of] Sophia are incomplete [and] formless, Jesus [contrived] a creature of this [sort] and made it of the seeds while Sophia worked with him. [For] since they are seeds and [without form], he descended [and brought] forth that pleroma [of aeons] which are in that place, [since even the uncreated ones of] those [Aeons are of] the pattern of the [Pleroma] and the [uncontainable] Father. The Uncreated One [brought forth the pattern] of the uncreated, for it is from the uncreated that the Father brings forth into form. But the creature is a shadow of pre-existing things. Moreover, this Jesus created the creature, and he worked from the passions surrounding the seeds. And he separated them from one another, and the better passions he introduced into the spirit and the worse ones into the carnal.

Now first among [all] those passions [...] nor [...] him, [since, after all], Pronoia caused [the] correction to project shadows and images of [those who] exist [from] the first and [those who] are [and] those who shall be. This, [then, is] the dispensation of believing in Jesus for the sake of [him who] inscribed the All with [likenesses and] images [and shadows].

After Jesus brought [forth further] he brought [forth] for the All those of the Pleroma and of the syzygy, that [is, the] angels. For simultaneously with the [agreement] of the Pleroma her consort projected the angels, since he abides in the will of the Father. For this is the will of the Father: not to allow anything to happen in the Pleroma apart from a syzygy. Again, the will of the Father is: always produce and bear fruit. That she should suffer, then, was not the will of the Father, for she dwells in herself alone without her consort.

Let us [...] another one [...] the Second [...] the son of another [...] is the Tetrad of the world. [And] that Tetrad put forth [fruit] as if the Pleroma [of the world were] a Hebdomad. And [it] entered [images] and [likenesses and angels] and [archangels, divinities] and [ministers].

When all [these things were brought to pass by] Pronoia [...] of Jesus who [...] the seeds [...] of Monogenes [...]. Indeed they are [spiritual] and carnal, the heavenly and the earthly. He made them a place of this sort and a school of this sort for doctrine and for form.

Moreover this Demiurge began to create a man according to his image on the one hand and on the other according to the likeness of those who exist from the first. It was this sort of dwelling place that she used for the seeds, namely [...]

[...] separate [...] God. When they [...] in behalf of man, [since] indeed [the Devil] is one [of] the divine beings. He removed himself and seized the entire [plaza] of the gates and he [expelled] his [own] root from [that] place [in the body] and [carcasses of flesh], for [he is enveloped] by [the

man] of God. And [Adam sowed] him. Therefore [he acquired] sons who [angered one another. And] Cain [killed] Abel his brother, for [the Demiurge] breathed into [them] his spirit. And there [took place] the struggle with the apostasy of the angels and mankind, those of the right with those of the left, those in heaven with those on earth the spirits with the carnal, and the Devil against God. Therefore the angels lusted after the daughters of men and came down to flesh so that God would cause a flood. And he almost regretted that he had created the world [...]

[...] the consort] and [Sophia and her Son] and the angels [and the seeds]. But the syzygy is the [complete one] and Sophia and Jesus and [the angels] and the seeds are [images of] the Pleroma. Moreover the Demiurge [cast a shadow over] the syzygy and [the] Pleroma, and Jesus and [Sophia] and the [angels] and the seeds. [The complete one glorifies] Sophia; the image [glorifies] Truth. [And] the glory [of the seeds] and Jesus [are] those of [Silence and] Monogenes. [And] the [angels] of the males and [the seminal ones] of the females [are] all Pleromas. Moreover whenever Sophia [receives] her consort and Jesus receives the Christ and the seeds and the angels, then [the] Pleroma will receive Sophia joyfully, and the All will come to be in unity and reconciliation. For by this the Aeons have been increased; for they knew that should they change, they are without change.

XI 40, 1-29

[...] according to [...] the type of [...] see him. It is fitting for [you at this time] to send thy Son [Jesus] Christ and anoint us so that we might be able to trample [upon] the [snakes] and [the heads] of the scorpions and [all] the power of the Devil since he is the shepherd of [the seed]. Through him we [have known] thee. And we [glorify] thee: [Glory] be to thee, the Father in the [Son, the Father] in the Son, the Father [in the] holy [Church and in the] holy [angels]! From now on he abides [for-ever in] the perpetuity of the Aeons, forever until the [untraceable] Aeons of the Aeons. Amen.

On Baptism A

XI 40, 30–41, 38

[This] is the fullness of the summary of knowledge which (summary) was revealed to us by our Lord Jesus Christ, the Monogenes. These are the sure and necessary (items) so that we may walk in them. But they are those of the first baptism [...]

[---- The first] baptism [is the forgiveness] of sins [...] said, [...] you to the [...] your sins the [...] is] a pattern of the [...] of the Christ [which is the] equal of the [...] within] him. [...]. For the [...] of Jesus [...]. Moreover, the first [baptism] is the forgiveness [of sins. We] are brought [from those] by [it into] those of the right, [that is], into the [imperishability which is] the Jordan. [But] that place is [of] the world. So we have [been sent] out [of the world] into the Aeon. For [the] interpretation of John is the Aeon, while the interpretation of that which [is] the Jordan is the descent which is [the upward progression], that [is, our exodus] from the world [into] the Aeon.

On Baptism B

XI 42, 1–43, 19

[... from the] world [into the Jordan] and from [the blindness] of the world [into the sight of] God, from [the carnal] into the spiritual, [from] the physical [into the] angelic, from [the created] into the Pleroma, [from] the world [into the Aeon], from the [servitudes] into sonship, [from] entanglements [into one another], from [the desert into] our village, from [the cold into] the hot, [from

...] into a [...], and we [...] into the [...] thus] we were brought [from] seminal [bodies into bodies] with a perfect form. [Indeed] I entered by way of example [the remnant] for which the Christ [rescued] us in the [fellowship] of his Spirit. And [he brought] us forth who are [in him, and] from now on the souls [will become] perfect spirits.

Now [the things] granted to us [by the first] baptism [...] invis[ible ... which] is his, since [... speak] about ...]

XI 43, 20-38

[We give] thanks [to you and we celebrate the eucharist], O Father, [remembering for the sake of] thy Son [Jesus Christ that they] come forth [...] invisible [...] thy [Son ...] his [love ...] to [knowledge ...] they are doing thy will [through the] name of Jesus Christ [and] will do thy will [now and] always. They are complete [in] every spiritual gift and [every] purity. [Glory] be to thee through thy Son [and] thy offspring Jesus Christ [from now] forever. Amen.

XI 44, 1-37

[...] in the [...] the [word] of the [...] the] holy one it is [...] food and [drink ...] Son, since you [...] food of the [...]! to us the [...] in the [life ...] he does [not boast ...] that is [...] Church [...] you are pure [...] thou art the Lord. [Whenever] you die purely, [you] will be pure so as to have him [...] everyone who will [guide] him to food and [drink]. Glory be to thee forever. Amen.